'Even if we were to hold that the state government had the requisite power and authority to issue the impugned notification,' the court said, 'still the same would be liable to be quashed on the ground of malfide exercise of power. Eloquent proof thereof is furnished by the following facts and circumstances as appearing on the record…

On a careful perusal of the police report submitted by the CBI on completion of the investigation (which runs into more than 100 pages) we find that it has made a detailed investigation from all possible angles before drawing the conclusion that the allegations of espionage did not stand proved and were found to be false…

If before taking up further investigation an opinion has already been formed regarding the guilt of the accused and, that too, at a stage when the commission of the offence itself is yet to be proved, it is obvious that the investigation cannot and will not be fair—and its outcome appears to be a foregone conclusion.

From the above facts and circumstances we are constrained to say that the issuance of the impugned notification does not comport with the known pattern of a responsible government bound by rule of law. This is undoubtedly a matter of concern and consternation. We say no more.

On the conclusions as above we allow thee appeals and quash the impugned notification. We direct the Government of Kerala to pay a sum of Rs 1,00,000 (Rupees one lakh) to each of the six accused-appellants as costs.'

But now, having just heard the three words 'we have won' from Advocate Muralidhar, so many things flashed through my mind— the humiliating arrest, the torturous interrogation, my tormentors who I had vowed to hunt down, my family that came back from the brink, my friends who stood by me, my career which would never be the same again …

'What happened?'

Meena was shaking me vigorously. My vision was blurred as tears roll down my cheeks.

'Tell me, what happened?' she repeated.

'We've won the case,' I said.